



A LOCAL-LIVING GUIDE

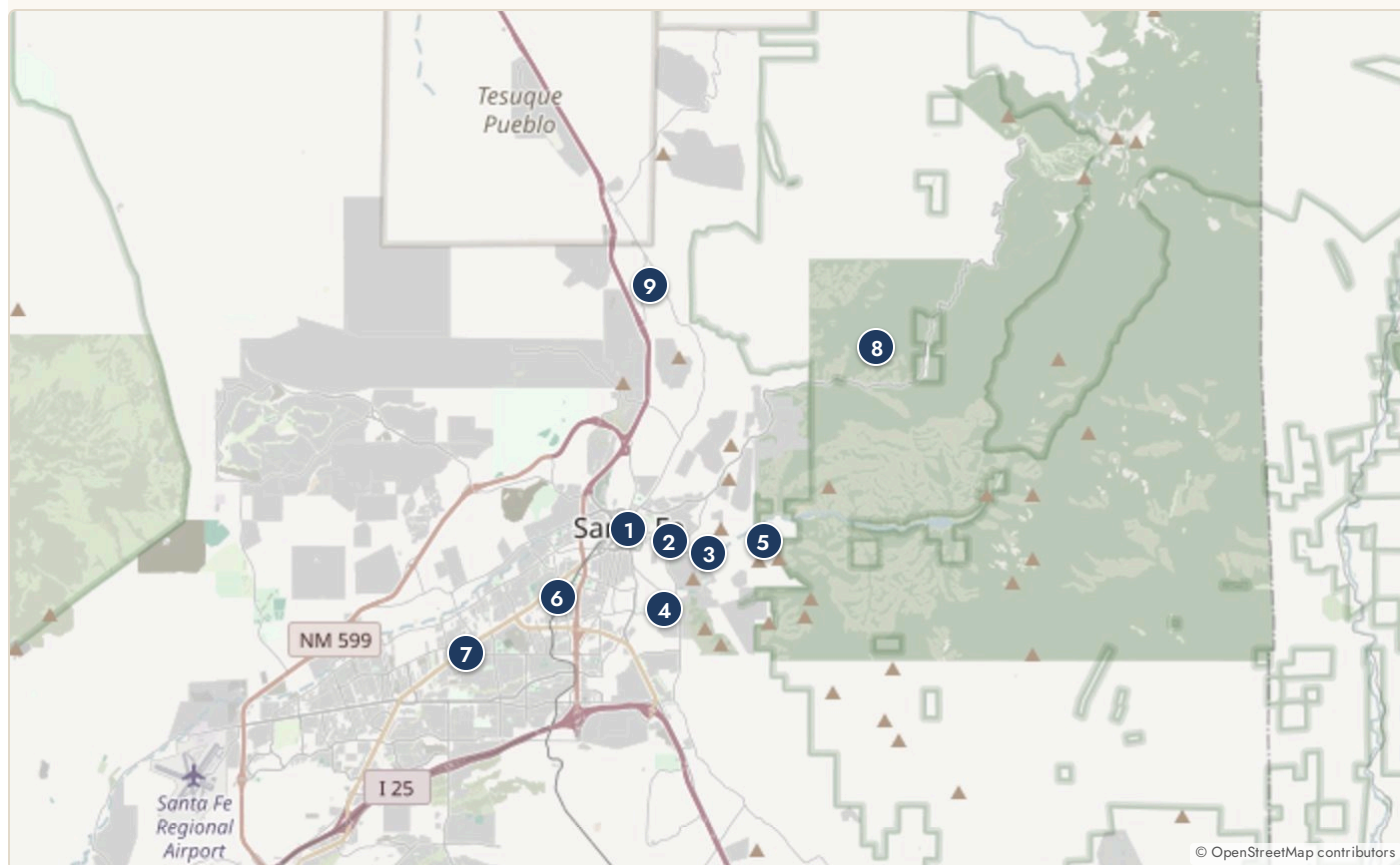
Santa Fe, *neighbourhood* by neighbourhood

Adobe lanes, red or green chile, Pueblo pottery and Canyon Road galleries, golden aspens and piñon smoke — a month of living at 7,200 feet, not just visiting.

ANDREW & SYLVAIN · EDITION OF SEPTEMBER 2026

The neighbourhoods

Santa Fe is a small city of about 90,000 spread along the foot of the Sangre de Cristo mountains. The old core — Plaza, Canyon Road, the Railyard — is walkable; Cerrillos Road runs south-west to Meow Wolf and the everyday city, and the Ski Road climbs east into the aspens. Each chapter opens with its own map, and every numbered bubble matches an entry in the listings.



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• Getting around: buses, trains & a car

• LGBTQ+ Santa Fe

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5 The Railyard & Guadalupe

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7 Siler Road, Cerrillos & the Southside

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Seasons, altitude & good habits

When to go

October is the sweet spot: highs about 17°C (63°F), nights near freezing, aspens gold on the Ski Road into early October, chile roasting at the market. November is quiet and cold (10°C / -3°C); snow is possible from late October to early April. Spring is windy; July–August bring afternoon monsoon storms.

Altitude

Santa Fe sits at 7,200 ft (2,195 m). Take the first two days gently, drink water all day, go lighter on alcohol, and wear sunscreen and a hat even in winter — the air is thin and very dry. Canyon Road and Museum Hill will leave you puffing.

Museums & the CulturePass

State museums (Art, History, Indian Arts, Folk Art) are open daily May–October and **closed Mondays November–April**; \$12 each. The **NM CulturePass** (\$30, 12 months) gives one visit to each of 15 state museums and sites — it pays for itself after three. It doesn't cover O'Keeffe, the Wheelwright or MoCNA.

Money & tipping

Prices are shown before tax: Santa Fe's gross receipts tax is 8.19% on most things. Tip 18–22% at table service, \$1–2 a drink, 15–20% for taxis. Buy jewellery straight from the Native artists under the Palace portal.

Pueblo etiquette

Pueblos are sovereign nations and feast days are religious ceremonies: no photos, video or sketching unless allowed, no applause, stay out of kivas and cemeteries. If a family invites you in to eat, accept and eat briefly. Pueblos close without notice — call ahead.

Entry for Canadians

Passport or NEXUS; no visa. Staying 30 days or more? The US registration rule (made permanent in June 2026) is covered by the electronic I-94 you get when flying in — download it at i94.cbp.dhs.gov after arrival and keep a copy. Driving in without an I-94 means filing Form G-325R online before day 30.



Adobe walls and chile ristras — Dicklyon · CC BY-SA 4.0

This autumn: Albuquerque Balloon Fiesta 3–11 Oct · Ski Santa Fe aspen chair rides 3–4 & 10–11 Oct · SITE Santa Fe reopens 16 Oct · Bandelier's free shuttle ends 14 Oct · Santa Fe Film Festival 14–19 Oct · Winter Spanish Market 5–6 Dec · Canyon Road farolito walk 24 Dec.

Buses, the Rail Runner & a few days' car

Santa Fe Pick-Up

A **free** downtown shuttle looping the Plaza, Cathedral, Canyon Road, the Capitol and the Railyard, about every 30 minutes, 8:30–19:00 (Sat to 20:00).

The free Blue Bus

All fixed NCRTD Blue Bus routes are **free**: 255 up the Ski Road to Ten Thousand Waves and the aspens, 200 to Tesuque and Española, 300/305 to Taos (weekdays / weekends). Check times in the ride.guide app.

Airports

Santa Fe Regional (SAF) has United via Denver and Chicago and American via Dallas, Phoenix and LA — 20 min to town. From Albuquerque's Sunport (1 h), NMShuttle runs to La Fonda and hotels (\$63 one way); Groome's shuttle ended in November 2025.

City buses

Santa Fe Trails: \$1 a ride, \$2 a day, \$20 for 31 days (seniors half). The Museum Hill route M is now call-for-pickup (505-955-2001). The free-Sundays trial ended in September.

Rail Runner

Commuter trains from the Railyard depot to Albuquerque in about 1 h 30 — around 12 trips on weekdays, 7 on Saturdays, 4 on Sundays. About \$9–11 each way; seniors 62+ half price and **free on Wednesdays**.

Taxis, cars & walking

Uber and Lyft work but thin out at night. Rent a car for a few days rather than the month — for Bandelier, Abiquiú, the High Road and Tent Rocks. Downtown meters are \$2 an hour (ParkMobile). The old town, the Railyard and the Rail Trail are made for walking.



The Rail Runner at the Santa Fe Depot — dconvertini · CC BY-SA 2.0

LGBTQ+ Santa Fe

The climate

One of America's most relaxed places for a gay couple. New Mexico has had marriage equality since 2013, broad anti-discrimination law and 2023 protections for gender-affirming care. Santa Fe has welcomed queer artists and writers for a century and has a large, older, couples-oriented gay community — the whole town is the gayborhood.

Pride

Santa Fe Pride, run by the Human Rights Alliance, fills June, with Pride on the Plaza and a parade on the last weekend (2026: 26–27 June; 2027 not yet announced). Albuquerque Pride is mid-June; Taos Pride is in August.

A queer-history walk

Garrett Peck's private LGBTQ+ Santa Fe tour (2–2.5 h, \$100 each, minimum two) runs from the Plaza — Willa Cather, Mary Colter, Claude's Bar on Canyon Road — to the Inn of the Turquoise Bear, home of the poet Witter Bynner and his partner Robert Hunt.

No gay bar — and why that's fine

The last dedicated bars (Rouge Cat, Blue Rooster) closed around 2015. Social life is a series of nights in mainstream places: **Friends of Dorothy** Friday socials (next: 2 Oct at Piñon Court), **Queer Night** at La Reina on Mondays, **Somewhere in the Rainbow** at The Mystic on the last Thursday, HRA drag bingo at Tumbleroot. Check gaysantafe.com and hrasantafe.org.

Community

The HRA Pride Center (1189 Parkway Dr) has drop-in hours Wed, Sat and Sun. Collected Works is the bookshop and talk venue. In Albuquerque, an hour away, there are proper gay bars: VERS (new in 2026, gay-owned, with a restaurant), the Albuquerque Social Club, Sidewinders.

Relaxed favourites

A drink in the garden at Secreto Lounge (Hotel St. Francis) or the Staab House Lounge at La Posada; Friends of Dorothy on a Friday; and one evening in Albuquerque at VERS with Nob Hill beforehand.

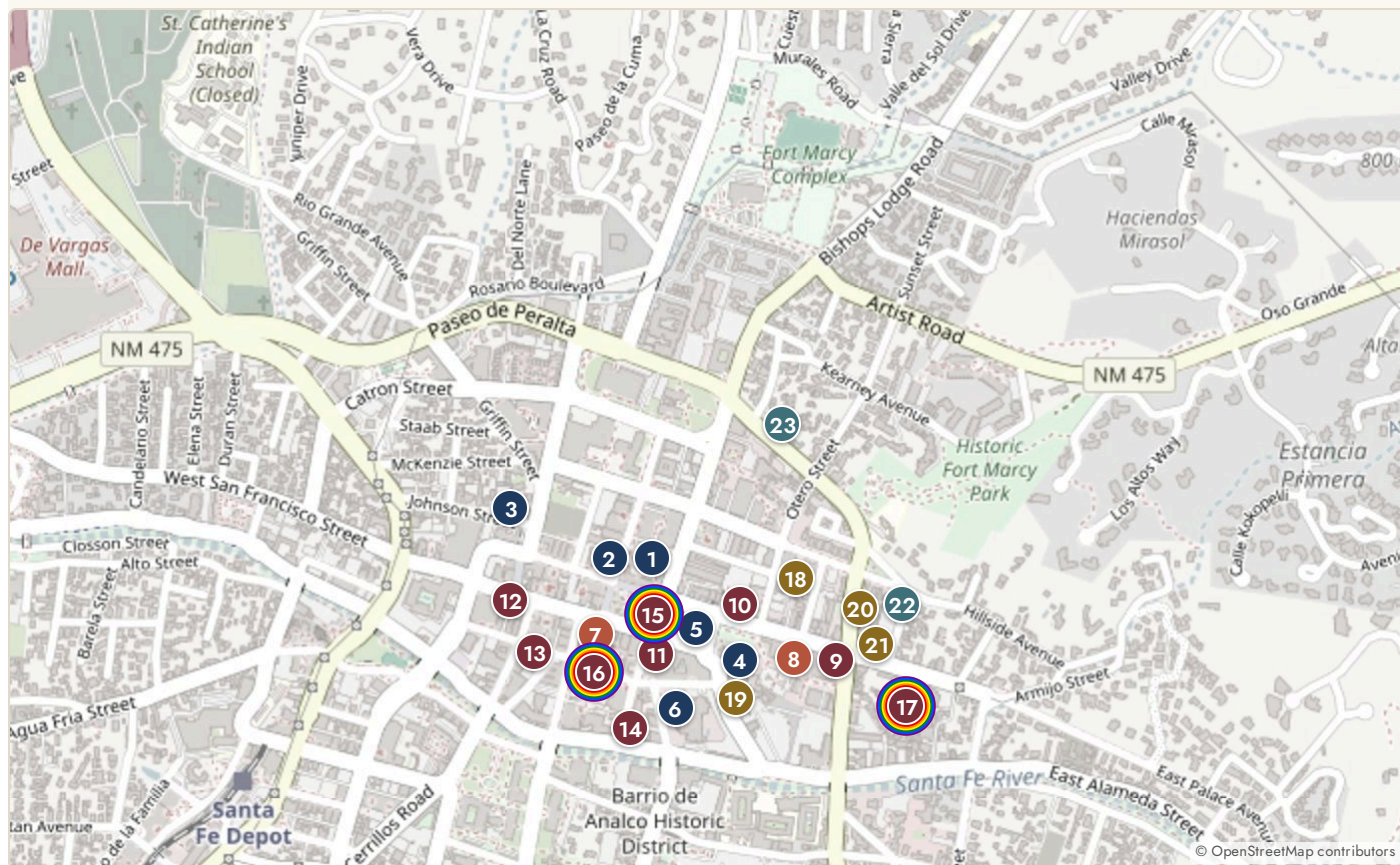


Pride in New Mexico — Jelippe · CC BY-SA 4.0

Throughout this guide, the  badge and rainbow-ringed map pins mark gay and LGBTQ+-friendly places. Closed, despite old listings: Rouge Cat, Blue Rooster, Claude's, Vanessie.

I The Plaza & Historic Downtown

The town square since about 1610 and the end of the Santa Fe Trail. Living a few blocks away means starting the day under the cottonwoods while Native artists lay out silver and turquoise under the Palace portal; everything is a 2–10 minute walk. Busiest 11:00–15:00; a quiet small town again by 20:00, especially November to April.



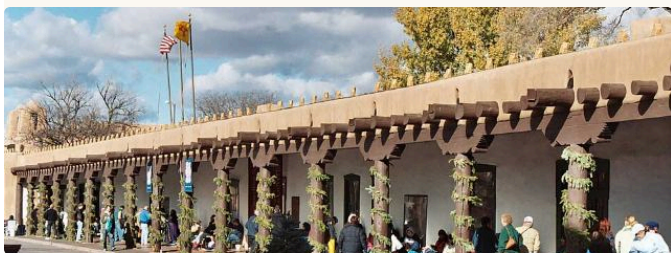
● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping & Galleries ● Walks & Hidden Corners
 ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Palace of the Governors & NM History Museum** — The Palace (about 1610) is the oldest continuously used public building in the US; the modern History Museum is behind it. \$12 or CulturePass. Open daily to October (Fri to 19:00); closed Mondays Nov–Apr.
- 2 **New Mexico Museum of Art** — The 1917 building that invented the Santa Fe style, with the Taos and Santa Fe art colonies and the lovely St Francis Auditorium. \$12 (also covers the Vladem in the Railyard); free 17:00–19:00 on the first Friday.
- 3 **Georgia O'Keeffe Museum** — Daily 10:00–17:00, \$24, timed tickets online. A new campus on Grant Avenue is being built for 2028, so expect works a block away. Book ahead during Balloon Fiesta week.
- 4 **Cathedral Basilica of St Francis** — Archbishop Lamy's French Romanesque cathedral (1869–86); La Conquistadora, the oldest Madonna in the US, is in the side chapel. Free. Tue–Fri 9:30–16:00, Sat to 15:00; closed Mondays.

5 IAIA Museum of Contemporary Native Arts — The country's leading museum of contemporary Indigenous art — sharp and political. \$10 (62+ \$5), **free on Fridays**. Closed Tuesdays.

6 Loretto Chapel — An 1878 Gothic chapel with the “Miraculous Staircase”, a spiral with no central support. About \$5; go at 9:00 to have it nearly to yourselves. Closes for weddings.



Bill Johnson - User: (WT-shared) Bill-on-the-Hill · CC BY-SA 4.0

CAFÉS & SWEETS

7 Five & Dime (Frito pie) — A souvenir shop with a lunch counter at the back, for the famous Frito pie: red chile and beef ladled into the bag, eaten on a Plaza bench.

8 35° North Coffee — Cold brew and croissants with upstairs seats looking straight down onto the Plaza. Wolf & Mermaid Roasters by the O'Keeffe is the small-batch alternative.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

9 La Fonda: Bell Tower & La Fiesta Lounge — The fifth-floor Bell Tower is the classic sunset-margarita terrace, open from late April until about late October. La Fiesta Lounge downstairs is the year-round fallback: daily 11:00–22:00, live music nightly.

10 The Shed — In a 1692 hacienda since 1953: blue-corn enchiladas “Christmas”, garlic bread, mocha cake. Mon–Sat; lunch walk-in, dinner bookable (505-982-9030). Closed Sunday.

11 Café Pasqual's — A tiny, riotously decorated room famous for organic breakfasts — huevos motuleños, chorizo breakfast burrito. Breakfast and lunch daily 8:00–15:00 (walk-in, arrive early), dinner from 17:30 (book).

12 Tia Sophia's — Michelin Bib Gourmand family diner of 50-plus years that claims the breakfast burrito. Order it “Christmas” with a sopaipilla. Breakfast and lunch only; closes early afternoon.

13 Coyote Café & Rooftop Cantina — Where Modern Southwestern cooking began in 1987. The rooftop cantina is walk-in from 11:30 for margaritas and tacos; the dining room is dinner from 17:00, book ahead.

14 Sazón — Fernando Olea's James Beard–winning contemporary Mexican, built around his moles — the special-occasion dinner. Mon–Sat 17:00–20:00; Thursday agave tastings.

15 The Matador **LGBTQ+** — A basement punk dive near the Plaza that locals call the closest thing left to a gay dive bar — a mixed, 30-plus crowd.

16 Secreto Lounge **LGBTQ+** — Garden-to-glass cocktails in the old Hotel St. Francis, listed by LGBTQ+ guides as a relaxed, gay-friendly drink a block from the Plaza.

17 Staab House Lounge **LGBTQ+** — A quiet Victorian lounge in La Posada's 1880s mansion — a conversational drink, and on gay guides' short list.

SHOPPING & GALLERIES

18 Native artisans under the portal — Every day 8:30–17:00, vetted Pueblo, Navajo and other Native artists sell their own work on blankets: silver, turquoise, heishi, pottery. Ask about their pueblo and technique — the most honest jewellery shopping in town.

19 Keshi — The Zuni Connection — Zuni carved fetishes arranged by animal and carver, plus Zuni jewellery. Staff explain each animal's meaning; gifts under \$100.

20 Shiprock & Santa Fe Dry Goods — Upstairs, museum-grade historic Navajo rugs and jewellery; downstairs, three linked boutiques for clothes, shoes and ceramics (Tue–Sat).

21 Collected Works Bookstore — Voted best bookshop 18 years running, with a coffee bar and a strong author and lecture series — the rainy-day local. Daily 9:00–17:00.

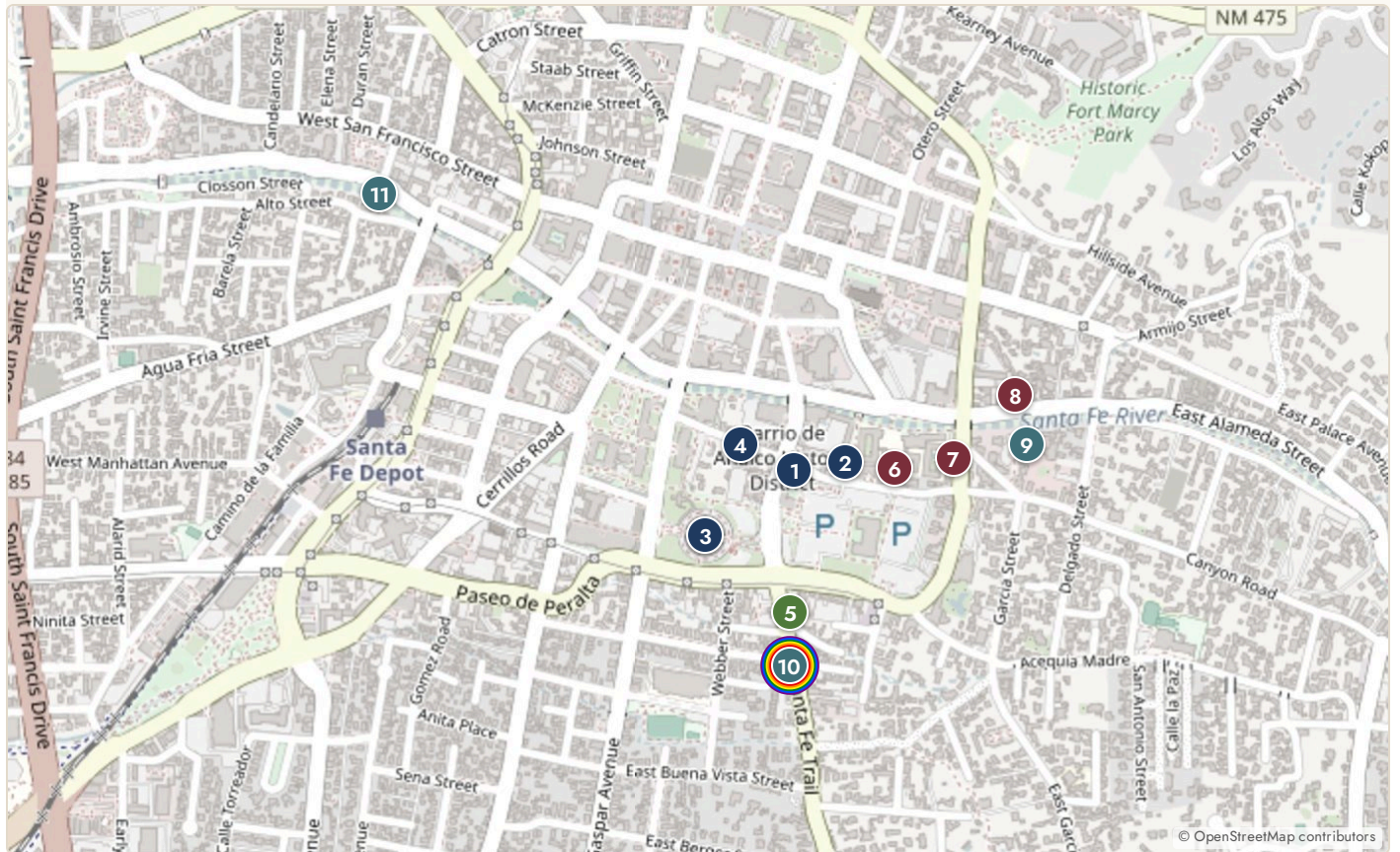
WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

22 Sena Plaza & Burro Alley — Through the passage at 125 E Palace, a hidden 1800s hacienda courtyard garden. Burro Alley, by the Lensic, recalls the woodcutters' burros and Doña Tules' gambling hall.

23 Cross of the Martyrs — A short brick path of history plaques up to the white cross for the friars killed in the 1680 Pueblo Revolt. Come at sunset for the view over downtown to the Jemez.

2 Barrio de Analco & South Capitol

Cross the little Santa Fe River south of the Plaza into Barrio de Analco, settled in the 1600s by Tlaxcalan servants of the Spanish — one of the oldest European-built neighbourhoods in the US. Beyond it, South Capitol is quiet adobe streets, lilacs and the round Capitol: a neighbourhood market, a pizza joint, a riverside path and the Witter Bynner house.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping & Galleries ● Walks & Hidden Corners

🌈 LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **San Miguel Chapel** — Built about 1610 and claimed as the oldest church in the US; docents on hand. Mon–Sat 10:00–15:00, Sun 12:00–15:00; \$7 (65+ \$5), card only.
- 2 **The “Oldest House”** — Its roof beams date to 1740–67, but the puddled-adobe walls may be pre-Spanish Pueblo work. Inside, a small shop — a ten-minute stop.
- 3 **The Roundhouse (State Capitol)** — The only round state capitol, shaped like the Zia sun from above, with a **free** collection of about 600 works by New Mexico artists and 6.5 acres of sculpture gardens. Weekdays only.

- 4 **Santa Fe Playhouse** — A tiny adobe community theatre from the 1920s. Sondheim's *Company* runs 19 Nov–20 Dec 2026; pay-what-you-will previews and \$10 rush seats.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 5 **Kaune's Neighborhood Market** — An old-school grocer since 1896 — meat counter, wine, local chile, made-to-order sandwiches. The best pantry for an apartment stay. Closed Sunday.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 6 **The Pink Adobe & Dragon Room** — The 1944 landmark reopened in May 2026 with a rebuilt kitchen: order the Steak Dunigan or the Gypsy Stew. Dinner Tue–Sun, book; the Dragon Room bar (and its wooden monkey) from 16:00.
- 7 **Upper Crust Pizza** — The neighbourhood pizza joint beside San Miguel: green-chile pizza on the porch, no reservations, and it delivers.
- 8 **Joe's Tequila Bar** — Best cocktails in the 2026 Best of Santa Fe: 250-plus tequilas and mezcal on a flower-draped patio across from the river path. Daily 11:30–21:00.



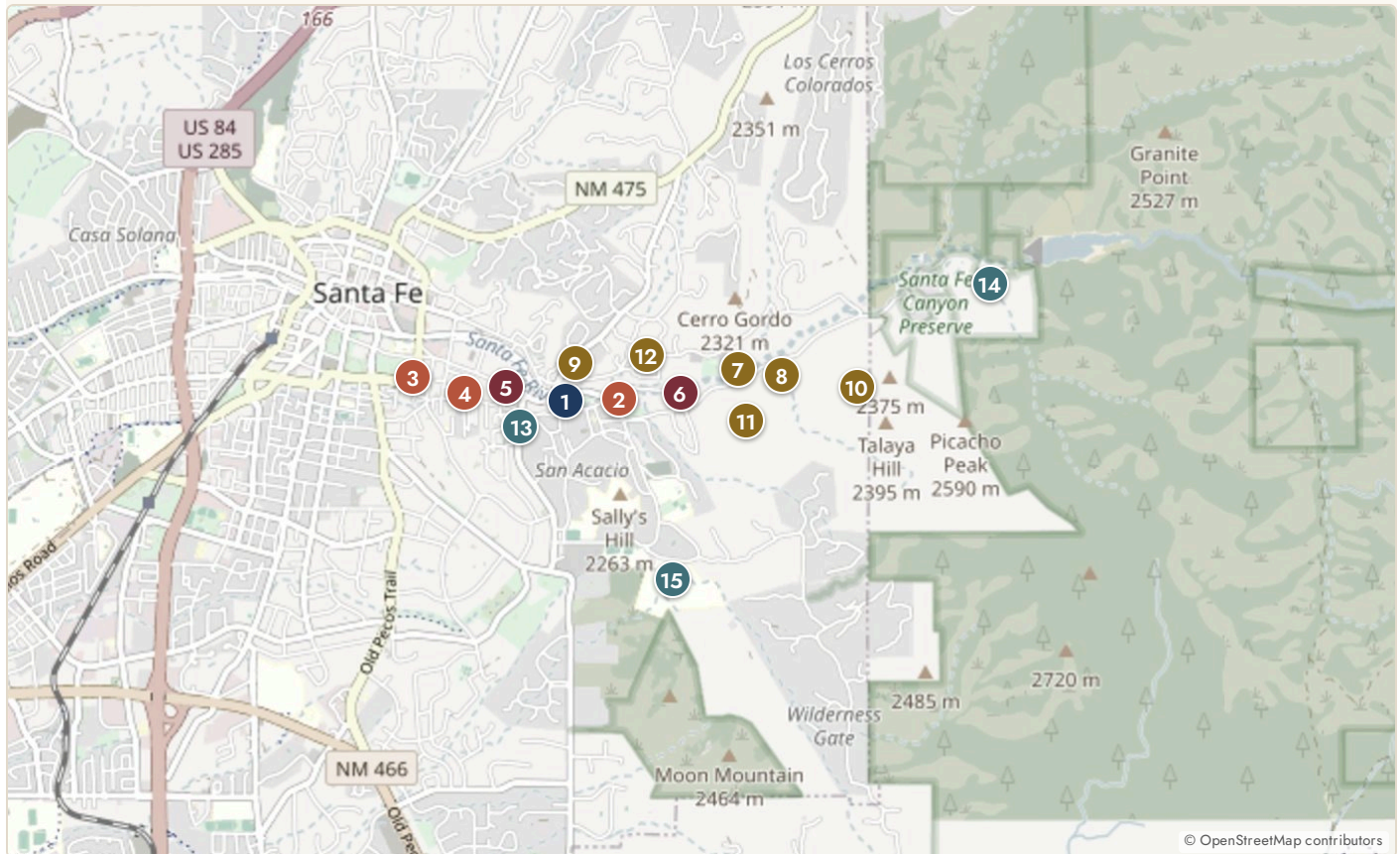
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WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 9 **East De Vargas Street** — The most atmospheric four blocks in town: low adobe walls, blue doors, history plaques and the tiled courtyards of the Inn of the Five Graces. Early morning or dusk.
- 10 **Inn of the Turquoise Bear**  — The adobe home of the gay poet Witter Bynner and his partner Robert Hunt, who entertained O'Keeffe, Cather, Auden and Martha Graham. Now a nine-room B&B and the end of the queer-history walk.
- 11 **Santa Fe River Park** — A cottonwood-shaded path along the (often dry) river beside Alameda Street — an easy, flat 2–3 km morning walk from Guadalupe Street to Patrick Smith Park.

3 Canyon Road & the Eastside

A half-mile of old adobe homes turned into more than 100 galleries, climbing east until the pavement gives way to a quiet dirt lane. The best of it is the back lanes — Acequia Madre, Garcia Street, Upper Canyon — walled, cottonwood-lined and residential. Come early, or on a Friday evening for the openings.



- Sights & Museums
- Cafés & Sweets
- Restaurants & Bars
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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 Cristo Rey Church** — John Gaw Meem's 1940 church of some 180,000 hand-made adobes — perhaps the largest adobe building in the US — built for the carved stone altar screen of 1761.



MARELBU · CC BY 3.0

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 2 Santa Fe Teahouse** — Where the galleries end: 80-plus teas, a shaded patio, a nearly gluten-free kitchen and Sunday jazz brunch. Thu–Mon; closed Tue and Wed.
- 3 Kakawa Chocolate House** — Drinking-chocolate “elixirs” from Mesoamerican and European recipes — try a chile one — and handmade truffles. Mon–Sat 11:00–18:00, Sun from 12:00.
- 4 Downtown Subscription** — The Eastside's coffeehouse and newsstand, with a magazine wall and a patio of locals — the base for the Acequia Madre loop.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 5 **The Compound** — Santa Fe's first fine-dining room, designed by Alexander Girard; seasonal American-Mediterranean cooking. Tue–Sat; lunch is the relaxed way to see the room.
- 6 **Geronimo** — In the 1756 Borrego House, with kiva fireplaces: peppery lobster and elk tenderloin. Special-occasion prices; book (505-982-1500).



MARELBU · CC BY 3.0

SHOPPING & GALLERIES

- 7 **Nedra Matteucci Galleries** — At the foot of Canyon Road: a sculpture garden with bronzes and a pond, and Taos Society and Western masters inside. Wander freely.
- 8 **Gerald Peters Gallery** — Since 1972, nationally respected for American Western and Modernist art. Mon–Sat 10:00–17:00.
- 9 **Morning Star Gallery** — The street's best for historic Native art — classic Pueblo pottery, Plains beadwork, textiles, old jewellery — and truly expert staff. Mon–Sat, closed Sunday.
- 10 **Zaplin Lampert Gallery** — Early Santa Fe and Taos painting and historic New Mexico photography in small adobe rooms that feel like a private museum.
- 11 **Turner Carroll Gallery** — The street's sharpest contemporary gallery — Hung Liu, Judy Chicago, Kara Walker. Now mostly by appointment: call 505-986-9800.
- 12 **Canyon Road Contemporary** — Twenty-five artists in glass, ceramics, bronze and paint, with a garden — approachable, and good for smaller purchases.

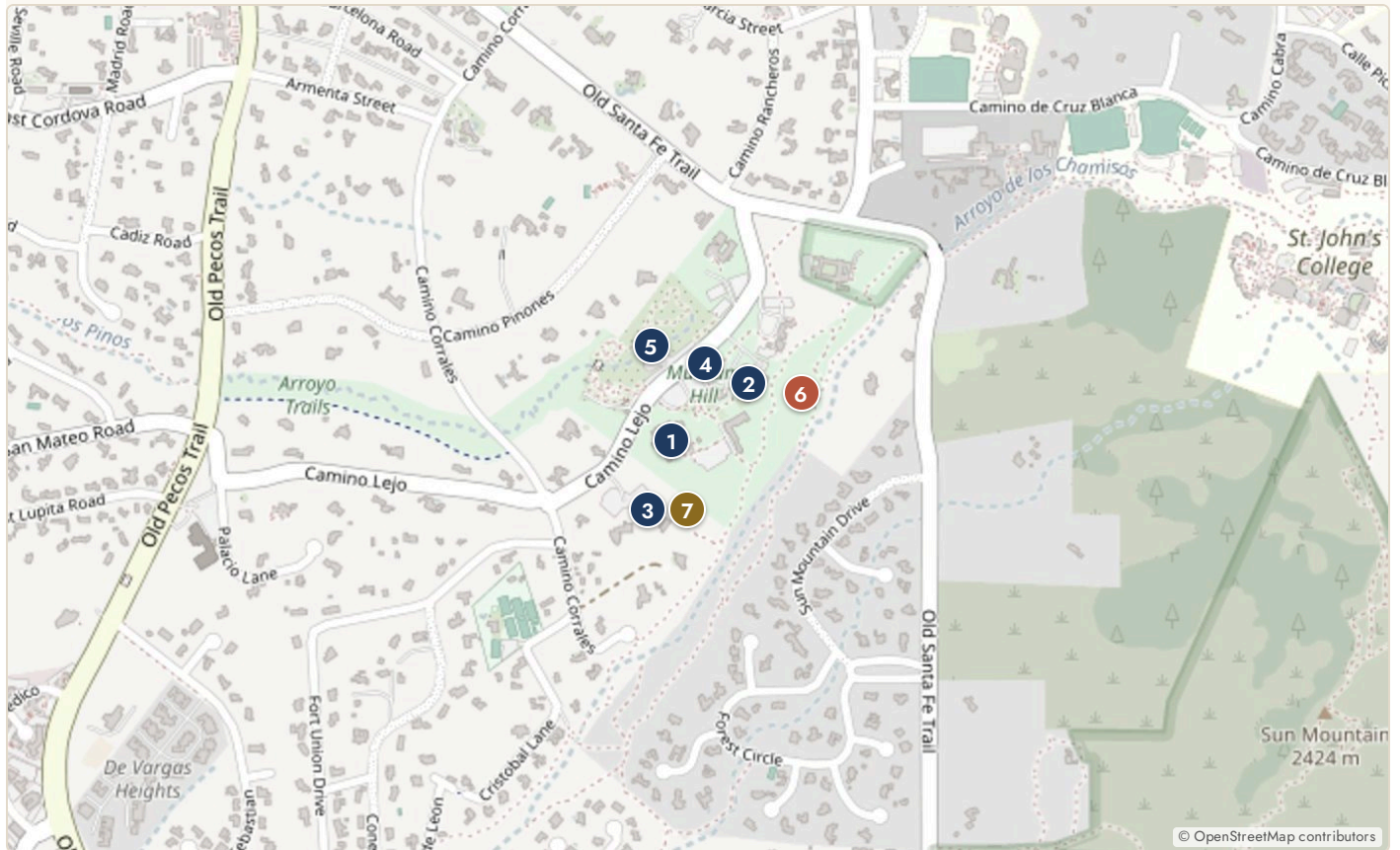
WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- **Friday openings** — Many galleries open new shows on Friday evenings, about 17:00–19:00, with wine and the artists. Pick up Friday's *Pasatiempo* in the New Mexican to see who's opening.

- 13 **Acequia Madre & Garcia Street loop** — A flat 3 km loop beside the 17th-century “mother ditch”, still flowing past old adobes, and back by Garcia Street — loveliest when the cottonwoods turn in October.
- 14 **Upper Canyon Road & Randall Davey Audubon** — Beyond the Teahouse the valley narrows under wooded hills to the painter Randall Davey's house and bird sanctuary: free grounds, Saturday bird walk at 8:30, house tour Fridays at 14:00 (\$8).
- 15 **Atalaya Mountain** — The in-town summit hike from St. John's College: to 9,125 ft, about 540 m of climbing. Go early, with water.

4 Museum Hill

The Old Santa Fe Trail climbs out of town to a piñon-covered ridge where four museums, a botanical garden and a café with long views share one plaza. A full day, best on a weekday — and it's about 3 km uphill from the Plaza, so take the call-for-pickup bus or a taxi up and walk down.



- Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping & Galleries ● Walks & Hidden Corners
- LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 Museum of International Folk Art** — Alexander Girard's "Multiple Visions" — 10,000 toys, dioramas and miniature villages — could fill half a day. Now: "Fantasy Coffins of Ghana" and "I Am Clay: Acoma Life in Figures". \$12 or CulturePass.
- 2 Museum of Indian Arts & Culture** — "Here, Now and Always" is the best introduction to the Southwest's Native peoples, and the pottery gallery is superb. New: "Route 66 is Indian Country". \$12 or CulturePass; closed Mondays Oct–Apr.
- 3 Wheelwright Museum** — An independent museum (1937) in a building shaped like a Navajo hogan, strong on weaving and contemporary jewellery. Tue–Sat, \$10 (not on the CulturePass).
- 4 Nuevo Mexicano Heritage Arts Museum** — The former Spanish Colonial Art museum, renamed and **free** since 2024: santos, tinwork, colcha embroidery, even lowrider bikes, in a John Gaw Meem house. Tue–Sat.
- 5 Santa Fe Botanical Garden** — A piñon-juniper hillside of native planting, at its best in autumn with chamisa and asters. Daily to October; Wed–Sun from November.



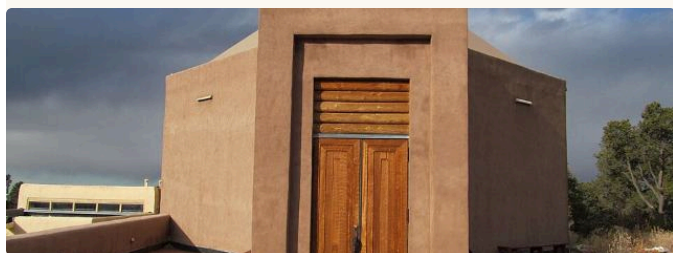
Christine Rondeau · CC BY 2.0

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 6 **Museum Hill Café** — Lunch on the terrace facing the Jemez and Sangre de Cristo ranges; weekend brunch with Sunday live music. Call ahead — hours vary.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- **Harry's Roadhouse** — Out on the Old Las Vegas Highway, a rambling locals' favourite for 30 years: lemon-ricotta pancakes, smoked ribs, pie. Wed–Mon; a short taxi from Museum Hill.
- **Jambo Bobcat Bite** — The old Bobcat Bite roadhouse, now run by Jambo's chef Ahmed Obo — burgers and brunch with East African and New Mexican spices. Weekday lunch and Saturday brunch.



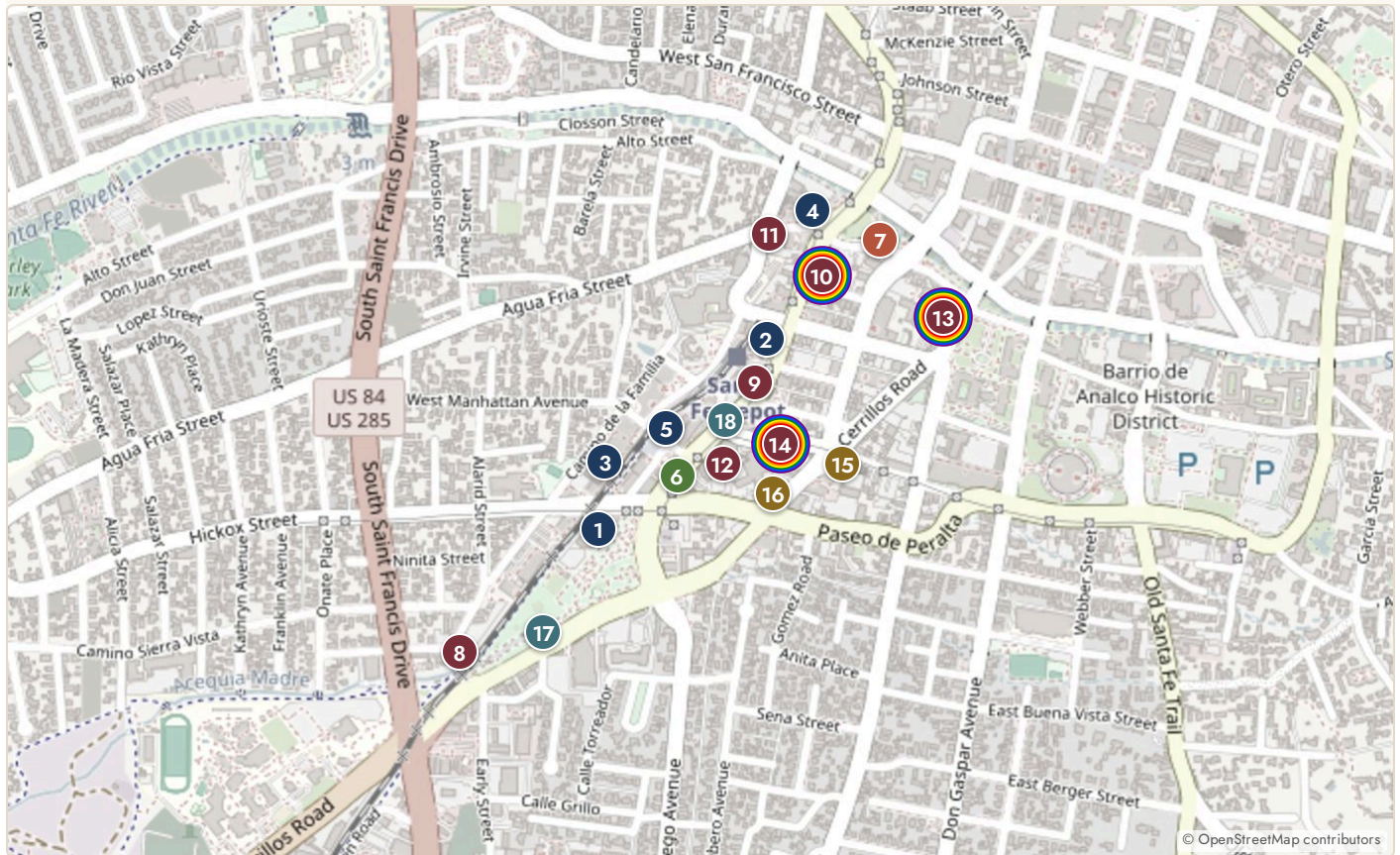
John Phelan · CC BY 3.0

SHOPPING & GALLERIES

- 7 **Case Trading Post** — The Wheelwright's old-style trading post: everything Native-made, the money to the artists — one of the most trustworthy places in town to buy.

5 The Railyard & Guadalupe

Old rail sheds, a water tower and a working depot have become Santa Fe's everyday gathering place — contemporary art on one side, the farmers' market on the other. Flat and 10–15 minutes' walk from the Plaza, it's where the Rail Runner and most buses meet, and on Saturday mornings the whole town is here.



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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 SITE Santa Fe** — Big, always-free contemporary art space. Between shows until **16 Oct 2026**, then Larry Bell and Sayre Gomez to January. Thu–Mon.
- 2 Vladem Contemporary** — The state art museum's contemporary branch in a renovated warehouse by the depot; same \$12 ticket as the Plaza building. Free 17:00–19:00 on the last Friday.
- 3 El Museo Cultural** — A community Hispanic and Chicano cultural centre in a huge warehouse — exhibitions, folklórico, markets. Thu–Sun.
- 4 Santuario de Guadalupe** — A late-1700s adobe, the oldest US church to Our Lady of Guadalupe, with José de Alzibar's huge 1783 painting inside. Mon–Sat 10:00–16:00.
- 5 Sky Cinemas Railyard** — The former Violet Crown: independent and foreign films with a kitchen, beer and wine, and free parking with your ticket.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 6 **Santa Fe Farmers' Market** — Saturdays year-round 8:00–13:00; Tuesdays 8:00–13:00 into late November. 150-plus growers selling their own produce — chile roasters in autumn, breakfast burritos first thing.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 7 **Iconik Coffee “Lupe”** — The town's best coffee (2026 poll), from a local roaster — a good first stop before the galleries.



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RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 8 **La Choza** — The Shed's sister and the 2026 pick for best New Mexican food, where locals eat to avoid the Plaza: carne adovada, posole, margaritas.
- 9 **Tomasita's** — Family-owned since 1974 in the old brick depot: stuffed sopaipillas and green chile stew. Expect a wait; the bar is quicker.
- 10 **Cowgirl BBQ**  — Railyard institution with a patio and live music; it hosted Santa Fe Pride's 2026 kick-off.
- 11 **Joseph's Culinary Pub** — Joseph Wrede's seasonal cooking and natural wines; the bar is first-come from 17:00. Wed–Sun.
- 12 **Second Street Brewery Railyard** — The 2026 best gastropub, with a patio beside the market — the post-market beer.

- 13 **Piñon Court**  — The La Fonda team's venue, host of the **Friends of Dorothy** Friday social on 2 Oct 2026 from 17:00 — check gaysantafe.com for later dates.
- 14 **As Above So Below Distillery**  — Cocktail lounge behind the cinema that has hosted Friends of Dorothy socials.

SHOPPING & GALLERIES

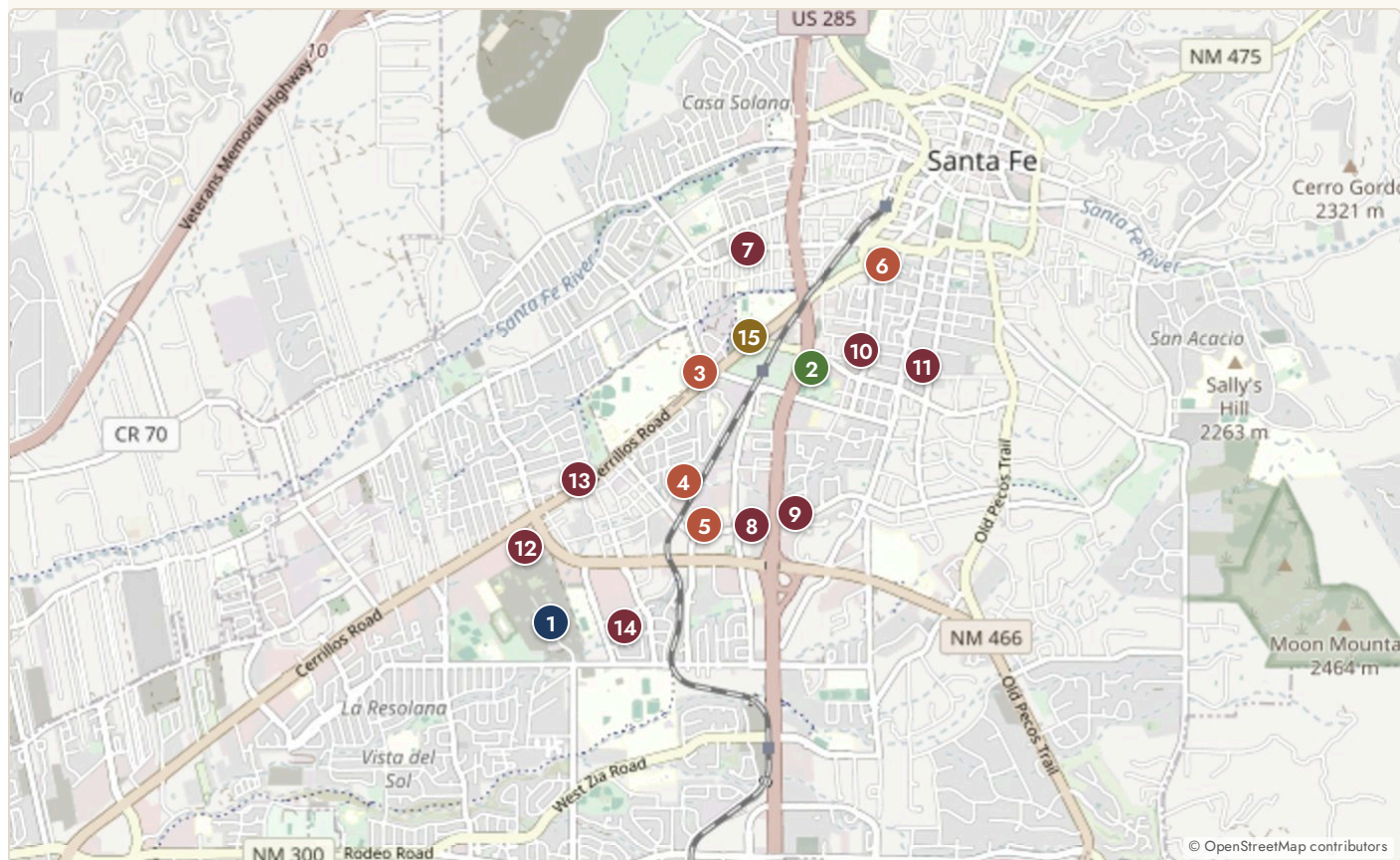
- 15 **Railyard Artisan Market** — Every Sunday 10:00–15:00 in the same pavilion: jewellery, crafts and fine art from changing makers.
- 16 **Railyard galleries** — LewAllen, Zane Bennett, Evoke, Charlotte Jackson and TAI Modern (Japanese bamboo) cluster on Guadalupe and Paseo — best on the Last Friday art walk.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 17 **Railyard Park & the Rail Trail** — Eleven acres of native grasses and an acequia; the paved Rail Trail starts here and runs 5.5 km south (and on, unpaved, toward Lamy).
- 18 **Sky Railway** — Excursion trains from the depot toward Lamy — the Scenic ride from \$99, a Sunset Serenade from \$109.

6 NEIGHBOURHOOD Second Street, Baca Street & Midtown

Where locals actually live: warehouse studios, cash-only brunch spots, coffee roasters and cheap, excellent food along West Cordova and lower Cerrillos. The old college campus in Midtown has reopened with a cinema and a wood-fired pizza place. A Baca Street–Second Street loop makes a relaxed half-day.



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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Sky Cinemas Midtown** — The old film school's single-screen cinema, reopened March 2026 with the biggest screen in town.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 2 **Trader Joe's** — The budget grocery for a self-catering month, in the same strip as Paper Dosa.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 3 **Counter Culture Café** — Cash-only neighbourhood institution with a patio, breakfast all day 8:00–15:00 — the anchor of the Baca Street makers' strip.
- 4 **Iconik Coffee "Lena"** — A big, airy warehouse café with full breakfasts and lunches. Daily 8:00–16:00.

- 5 **Chocolate Maven** — Brunch beside a glass wall onto the bakery — best croissants and cakes in the 2026 poll. Hidden down a warehouse lane.
- 6 **Modern General** — Café and general store from the Vinaigrette team: bowls, good coffee, homestead goods.



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RESTAURANTS & BARS

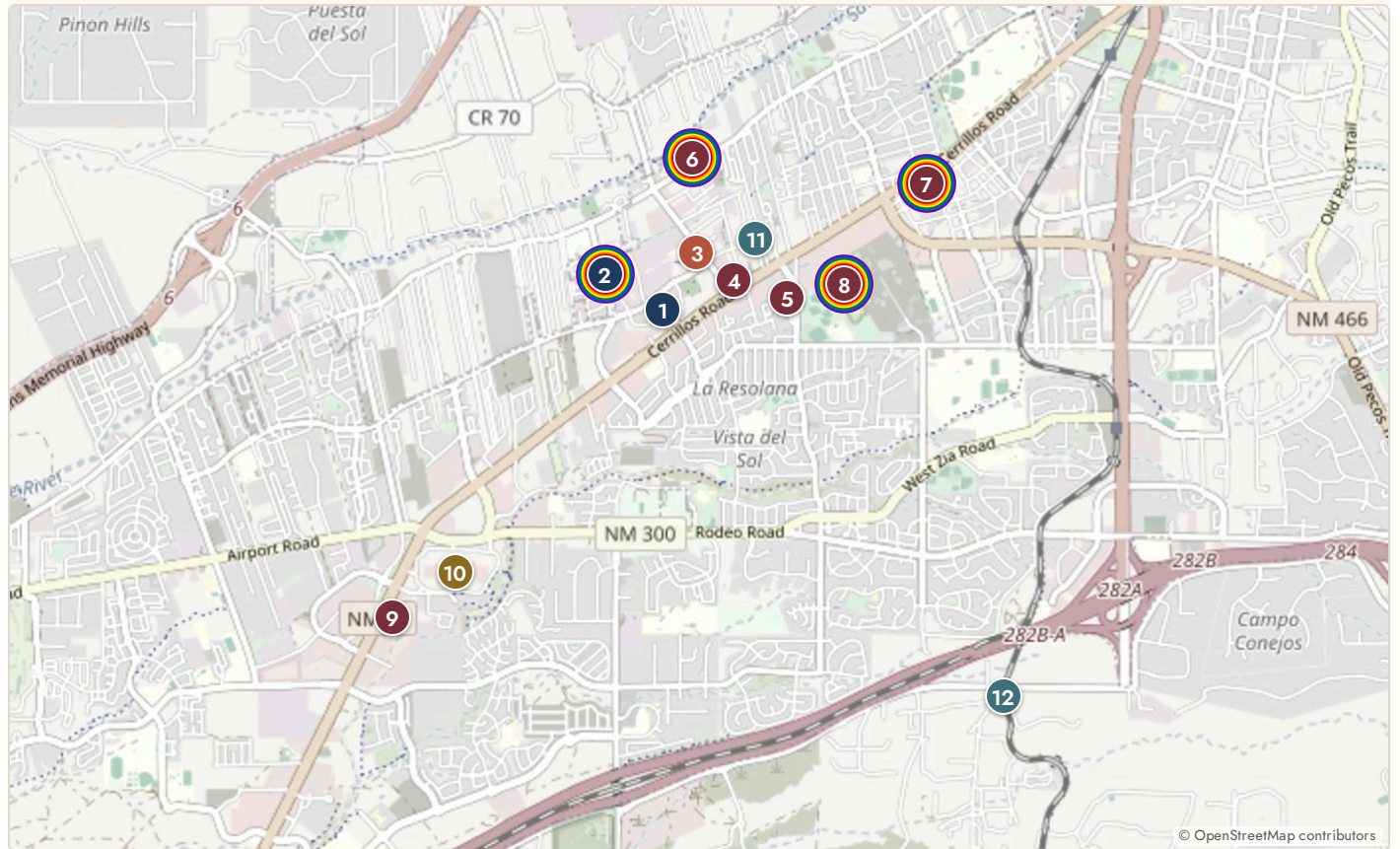
- 7 **Tune-Up Café** — New Mexican food with Salvadoran pupusas and banana-leaf tamales; the tres leches is locally famous. Open daily.
- 8 **Bonita** — Mexican family restaurant in the original Second Street Brewery building; runner-up for best new restaurant 2026.
- 9 **Back Road Pizza** — Best pizza 2026: cornmeal crust, local toppings, neighbourhood crowd.
- 10 **Paper Dosa** — Michelin-listed South Indian dosas and curries. Dinner Tue–Sat; book.
- 11 **Mariscos La Playa** — Cheerful Mexican seafood next door — ceviche, shrimp cocktails, caldo de mariscos — a long-time local lunch.
- 12 **Jambo Café** — Ahmed Obo's Swahili cooking — coconut chicken curry, goat stew — best chef and best international in 2026. Mon–Sat, in a strip mall.
- 13 **El Parasol** — Fast, cheap New Mexican counter famous for chicken-guacamole tacos; on the Green Chile Cheeseburger Trail.
- 14 **Tender Fire Kitchen** — Opened April 2026 after years as a pop-up: three-day sourdough wood-fired pizzas and mezcal cocktails.

SHOPPING & GALLERIES

- 15 **Baca Railyard studios** — Small experimental galleries — Pie Projects, Container — and the Santa Fe Art Auction in the new Baca blocks. Mostly part-time; check Instagram.

7 Siler Road, Cerrillos & the Southside

The light-industrial Siler–Rufina district is where Meow Wolf began: artists' housing, a greenhouse beer garden and taprooms among the auto shops. Further along, Cerrillos Road is strip malls, fierce green chile and two of the city's queer nights. Distances are long — plan around buses or take a rideshare.



SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Meow Wolf — House of Eternal Return** — The original walk-through art house: 70-plus rooms entered through a fridge or a fireplace. Timed tickets from \$32; allow 2–3 hours and go at opening on a weekday. Hours vary — check the calendar.
- 2 **HRA Pride Center**  — The Human Rights Alliance's community centre, run by Santa Fe Pride's organisers: drop-in Wed 10:00–14:00, Sat 9:00–11:30, Sun 14:00–16:30.



ObscuraNomad · CC BY 4.0

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 3 **Java Joe's** — Local roaster café full of tradespeople and artists; breakfast burritos.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 4 **Keeping Together** — A brewery and beer garden in a converted greenhouse full of plants, opened March 2026. Tue–Sun.
- 5 **Second Street Brewery Rufina** — The brewery’s local-crowd taproom, next door to Keeping Together.
- 6 **Tumbleroot Brewery & Distillery**  — Music venue and taproom, home of the Human Rights Alliance’s drag bingo and the Halloween Time Warp Ball.
- 7 **La Reina at El Rey Court**  — A mezcal bar in a restored 1936 motor court, with a dog-friendly patio. **Queer Night every Monday 19:00–22:00**, free, with part of the takings to the Transgender Resource Center.
- 8 **The Mystic**  — Restaurant and music venue hosting “Somewhere in the Rainbow”, the monthly queer night (last Thursday, 19:00–22:00), and a Sunday drag brunch.
- 9 **Horseman’s Haven** — Beside a gas station since 1981, famous for the hottest green chile in town (levels 1–5 — Level 2 comes on the side). Burritos big enough for two. Closed Monday.



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SHOPPING & GALLERIES

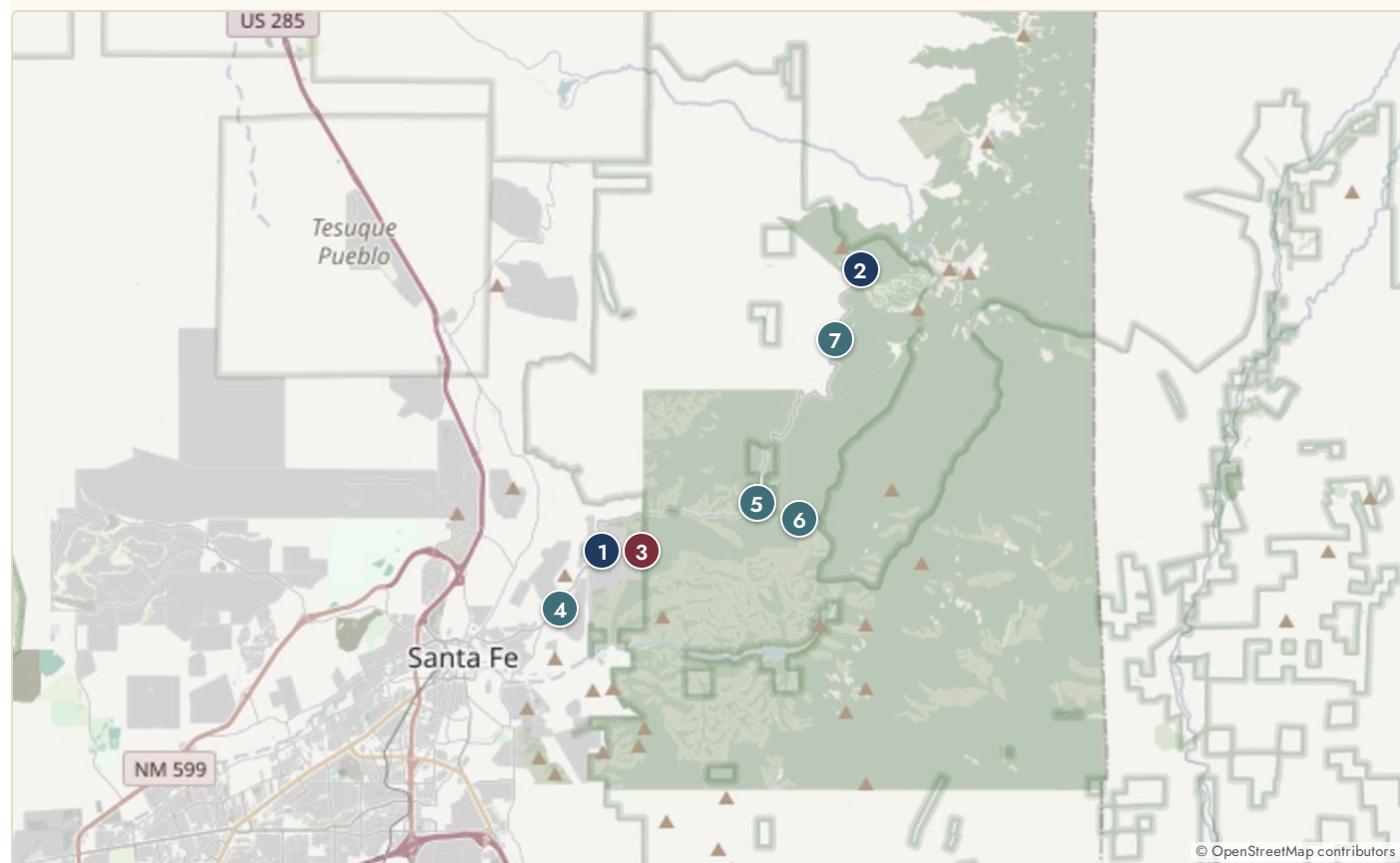
- 10 **Santa Fe Place** — The enclosed mall — Dillard’s and practical shopping, and a weather escape.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 11 **Siler Yard** — New Mexico’s first net-zero affordable housing for artists — worth seeing from outside; watch for open-studio days.
- 12 **Santa Fe Rail Trail** — The paved first 5.5 km of the Rail Trail runs from the Railyard down through the Southside to Rabbit Road — walk it one way and bus back.

8 NEIGHBOURHOOD The Ski Road: Hyde Park & the Aspens

One road climbs 26 km and nearly 1,000 m from the Plaza to Ski Santa Fe: a Japanese mountain spa, 1930s CCC picnic grounds and some of the largest aspen groves in the Southwest. In the last week of September and first of October whole slopes turn gold. The free Blue Bus 255 runs up all year.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping & Galleries ● Walks & Hidden Corners
 ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Ten Thousand Waves** — A Japanese-style onsen with hot tubs among the piñons. Private tubs \$89 each for 90 minutes, communal soaks \$64; everything by reservation. Book a private tub at dusk.
- 2 **Ski Santa Fe** — Base at 10,350 ft. Autumn chairlift rides over the aspens on 3–4 and 10–11 Oct 2026, 10:00–15:00 (call 505-982-4429); skiing November to April.

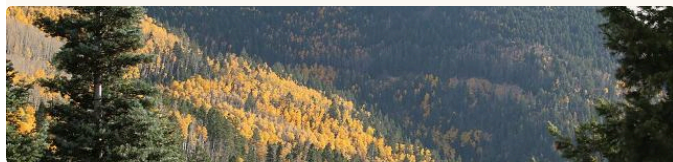
RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 3 **Izanami** — The spa's izakaya: small plates, wagyu, a big sake list, floor or table seating. Lunch Wed–Mon, dinner daily; happy hours 15:00–16:00 and 21:00–22:00.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

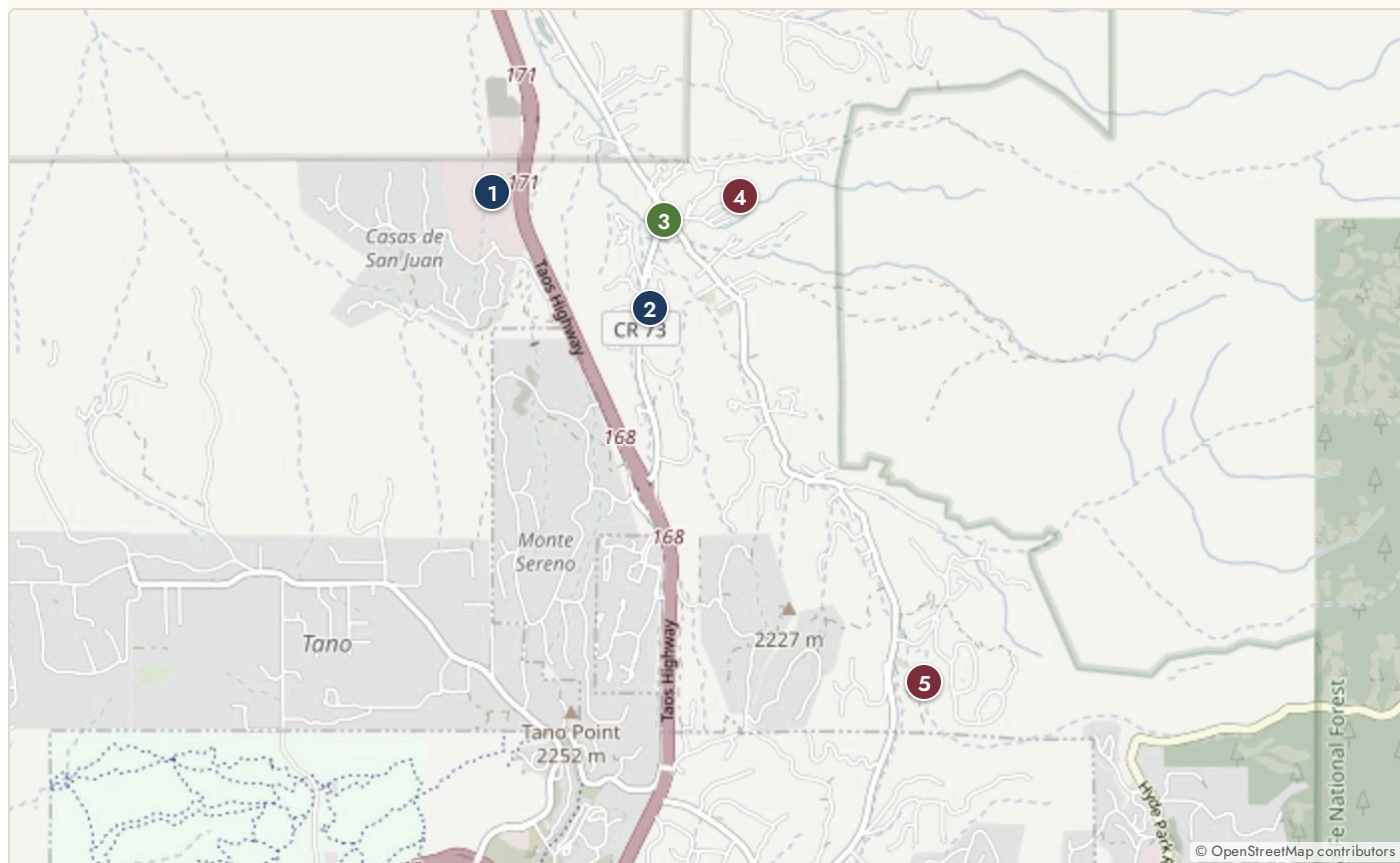
- 4 **Dale Ball Trails** — About 40 km of linked single-track through piñon foothills just above town; the 255 bus stops at the trailhead, so hike one way and ride back.
- 5 **Hyde Memorial State Park** — New Mexico's first state park, with a stone-and-log CCC lodge and trails along Little Tesuque Creek. No cell signal.
- 6 **Black Canyon** — A shady forest loop through mixed conifer about 12 km up the road — an easy stop from the bus.

- 7 **Aspen Vista** — A closed forest road climbing through solid aspen toward Tesuque Peak; the first 2–3 km give the famous gold tunnels. Weekday or before 9:00 — weekend parking overflows.



9 Tesuque & the Opera

A country village of horse properties and cottonwoods ten minutes north, with one excellent general store, a wood-fired restaurant and — across the highway — the open-air opera house with the sunset behind the stage. Outside the summer season it's a place for dinner; take a taxi.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping & Galleries ● Walks & Hidden Corners
 ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **The Santa Fe Opera** — The 2,128-seat open-air Crosby Theatre faces the western sunset. The 70th season runs 2 July–28 August 2027: *Tunandot*, *The Barber of Seville*, *Così*, *Kátya Kabanová*. Tailgate picnics in the car park are the ritual.
- 2 **Shidoni sculpture garden** — Five acres of bronzes around a once-famous foundry; the gallery closed in 2023 and the garden's status is uncertain — look before you go.

MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 3 **Tesuque Village Market** — The village's all-day café, bakery and grocery with a porch under the cottonwoods, 9:00–21:00 — a green-chile breakfast after a morning drive.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 4 **El Nido** — A historic roadhouse now doing wood-fired spit-roasts and house-made pasta under tin chandeliers, with a raw bar upstairs. Tue–Sun from 16:30.
- 5 **SkyFire at Bishop's Lodge** — Southwest cooking from a wood-fire kitchen at the Auberge resort on the forest's edge — a splurge lunch. Call ahead for day access.

From the Santuario to the Roundhouse

Four centuries in a morning: the oldest shrines, the Plaza, a French cathedral and a round capitol, all within a flat loop of the old town.

1 Start: Santuario de Guadalupe

The late-1700s adobe shrine at the edge of the Railyard.

2 Along the river to the O'Keeffe

East on Alameda under the cottonwoods, then up Johnson Street to the Georgia O'Keeffe Museum.

3 Museum of Art

The 1917 building that set the Santa Fe style, on the corner of the Plaza.

4 The Plaza & the Palace portal

Buy directly from the Native artists; see the Santa Fe Trail's end marker in the south-east corner.

5 Cathedral Basilica

East on San Francisco Street to Lamy's cathedral and La Conquistadora.

6 Loretto Chapel

The spiral "miraculous staircase", a few steps south.

7 San Miguel & the Oldest House

Across the river into the Barrio de Analco and along East De Vargas Street.

8 Finish: the Roundhouse

The free art collection in the Capitol (weekdays); ride the free Pick-Up back.



Cathedral Basilica of St Francis — SarahStierch · CC BY 4.0



Loretto Chapel — User:Camerafiend · CC BY-SA 3.0

Canyon Road & the Acequia Madre

The gallery street on the way up, the 17th-century irrigation ditch on the way down — best on an October morning or a Friday evening.

1 Start: Paseo de Peralta

Chocolate elixir at Kakawa, then the sculpture garden at Nedra Matteucci.

2 Up through the galleries

Densest in the first half-mile: Morning Star for historic Native art, Turner Carroll for contemporary.

3 El Zaguán

The Historic Santa Fe Foundation's house at 545 Canyon Road and its small public garden.

4 Cristo Rey & the Teahouse

The great adobe church at the top, then tea on the patio.

5 Camino del Monte Sol

Down the 1920s artists' street of Los Cinco Pintores.

6 Finish: the Acequia Madre

West along the “mother ditch” between old walls, and back by Garcia Street and Downtown Subscription.



The Acequia Madre — Netherzone · CC BY-SA 4.0

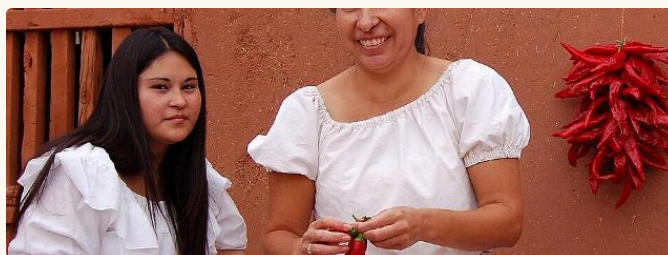
Red, green or “Christmas”

New Mexican food is its own cuisine, built on chile. The state question is “red or green?” — say “Christmas” for both.

DISH	WHAT IT IS	WHERE TO TRY IT
Red / green / “Christmas”	The two chile sauces — red from dried pods, green from roasted fresh	Everywhere
Hatch & Chimayó chile	Southern green chile roasted Aug–Oct; heirloom northern red	Farmers' Market roasters; Rancho de Chimayó
Carne adovada	Pork slow-braised in red chile	The Shed, La Choza
Posole	Hominy stew with pork and red chile	La Choza, The Shed
Blue-corn enchiladas	Stacked flat, often with an egg on top	The Shed, Tia Sophia's
Sopaipillas	Puffed fried bread — tear a corner and pour in honey; or stuffed and smothered	Tomasita's, The Shed
Breakfast burrito	Eggs, potato, bacon or chorizo, smothered in chile	Tia Sophia's, Horseman's Haven, Café Pasqual's
Frito pie	Chile and beef poured into the Fritos bag	Five & Dime on the Plaza
Green chile cheeseburger	The state burger	El Parasol, Horseman's Haven
Green chile stew	Pork, potatoes and green chile	Tomasita's, The Shed
Biscochitos	Anise-and-cinnamon cookie, the state cookie	Bakeries; Spanish Market stalls
Horno bread & piñon coffee	Beehive-oven bread from the pueblos; coffee with roasted pine nut	Pueblo feast days (cash); cafés



Chile ristras — Flickr user: Kolin Toney <https://www.flickr.com/> · CC BY-SA 2.0



Tying ristras — Larry Lamsa · CC BY 2.0

Markets & art by day

For a month-long stay, a weekly rhythm: markets in the Railyard, galleries on Friday nights, free museum hours.

DAY	WHAT	WHEN & WHERE
Daily	Native artists under the Palace portal	8:30–17:00, the Plaza
Tuesday	Farmers' Market	8:00–13:00 into late Nov, Railyard
Wednesday	Rail Runner free for seniors 62+	All day
Friday	IAIA MoCNA free; Canyon Road openings	Museum 10:00–17:00; openings about 17:00–19:00
First Friday	Museum of Art (Plaza) free	17:00–19:00
Last Friday	Vladem free; Railyard art walk	17:00–19:00
Saturday	Farmers' Market	8:00–13:00 year-round, Railyard
Sunday	Railyard Artisan Market	10:00–15:00, Railyard pavilion



Santa Fe Farmers' Market — U.S. Department of Agriculture Bob Nichols/Photo · Public domain

Festivals & feast days by month

Summer is market season, autumn is fiestas and balloons, winter is farolitos and Pueblo dances. Pueblo feast days are open to respectful visitors — never photograph without permission.

MONTH	WHAT'S ON
January	Kings Day dances at many pueblos (6 Jan); San Ildefonso feast (23 Jan); ski season
June	Santa Fe Pride all month — Pride on the Plaza and parade the last weekend; Albuquerque Pride mid-June
July	Santa Fe Opera (2 Jul–28 Aug 2027); International Folk Art Market (8–11 Jul 2027); Traditional Spanish Market (last weekend)
August	Santa Fe Indian Market (21–22 Aug 2027); Chamber Music Festival; Taos Pride
September	Burning of Zozobra (3 Sept 2027) and the Fiesta de Santa Fe; San Geronimo at Taos Pueblo (29–30 Sept)
October	Albuquerque Balloon Fiesta (3–11 Oct 2026); Golondrinas Harvest Festival (3 Oct); Nambé feast (4 Oct); Santa Fe Film Festival (14–19 Oct)
November	Día de los Muertos events (1–2 Nov); Tesuque and Jemez feast days (12 Nov); museums start Monday closures
December	Winter Spanish Market (5–6 Dec); Pojoaque feast (12 Dec); Canyon Road farolito walk (24 Dec); Christmas dances at several pueblos



Farolitos at Chimayó — Judyt57 · CC BY-SA 4.0



The burning of Zozobra — Will Keightley from Santa Fe, USA · CC BY-SA 2.0

Adobe & 400 years of history

Ancestral Puebloan villages stood here centuries before Governor Peralta founded La Villa de Santa Fe in 1610. The Pueblo Revolt drove the Spanish out in 1680; De Vargas returned in 1692. The Santa Fe Trail opened in 1821, the US took the town in 1846, the railway came in 1880 and statehood in 1912. Artists arrived in the 1920s, and the Manhattan Project ran its secret office at 109 East Palace in 1943. The “Santa Fe style” was promoted from 1912 and made law in 1957 — which is why almost everything is adobe-coloured.

	PUEBLO REVIVAL	TERRITORIAL
When	1905–1920s, modelled on pueblos and mission churches	1850s–1880s, when trail and railway goods met adobe
Look	Rounded earth-toned walls, stepped massing, projecting vigas, canales, deep small windows, portales on round posts	Flat roofs edged with fired brick, crisp corners, white wooden trim with pediments, square posts
Where to see it	Museum of Art (1917), La Fonda, the Palace portal, Cristo Rey (1940)	Sena Plaza and Palace Avenue houses; the Roundhouse (1966 Territorial Revival)
For contrast	Loretto Chapel and the Cathedral: Gothic and Romanesque	San Miguel and the Oldest House: true colonial adobe



New Mexico Museum of Art (1917) — PerryPlanet · Public domain



San Miguel Chapel — Bradley Weber · CC BY 2.0

Choosing your home base

Eastside & Canyon Road

Quiet historic adobe lanes, galleries and the Teahouse at your door, the Plaza 10–15 minutes on foot, the Pick-Up along Canyon Road — the most Santa Fe feel. Against it: the priciest, uphill walks, few groceries (Kaune's is the closest), tight parking.

Downtown & the Plaza

Walk to everything — museums, restaurants, the Cathedral, the gay-friendly hotel bars — and no car needed. Against it: busy in high season, mostly hotels and condos rather than casitas, and noise near bars.

Railyard, Guadalupe & South Capitol

The farmers' market, SITE and the Railyard galleries, the Rail Runner and Blue Bus 255 at the door, local cafés and somewhat better value in the South Capitol streets. Against it: less postcard-pretty, and South Capitol is 20–25 minutes from the Plaza on foot.

A *casita* — a small adobe guesthouse behind a main house, often with a kiva fireplace and courtyard — is the classic month's rental. Ask for a monthly rate; book October and the holidays early; check heating, snow clearing and a washer. From November a car becomes more useful, and the Blue Bus and Rail Runner cover the rest.



A Santa Fe casita — John Phelan · CC BY 3.0



Canyon Road — MARELBU · CC BY 3.0

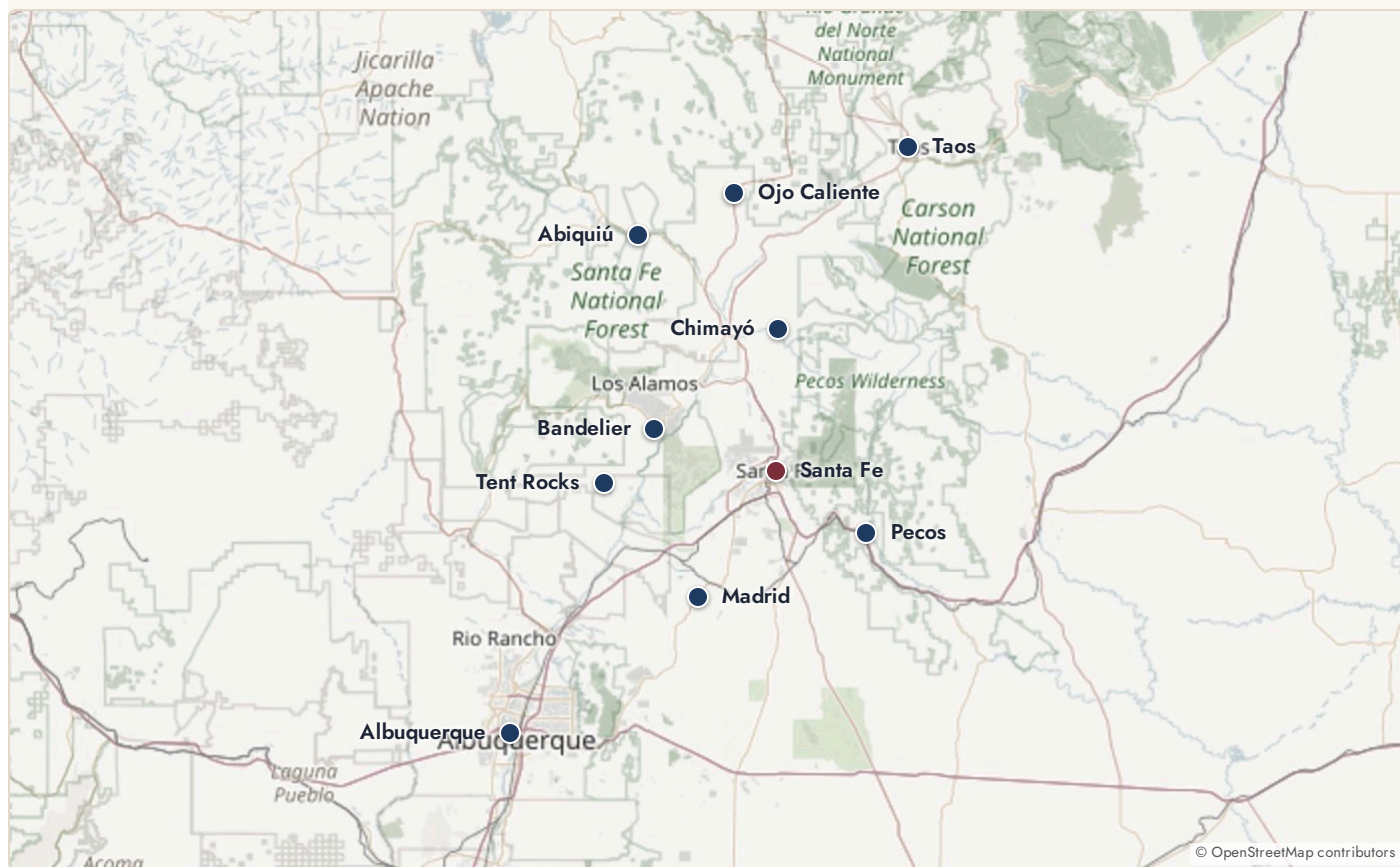


The Railyard — BFS Man from Webster, TX, USA · CC BY 2.0

Day trips and overnight extensions — Taos and the High Road, Abiquiú, Bandelier, the hot springs, Albuquerque and more — have their own chapters, starting on the next page.

Day trips & extensions

Northern New Mexico is a month of excursions on its own: pueblos, cliff dwellings, O'Keeffe country, hot springs and mountain villages. Rent a car for a few days; the free Blue Bus and the Rail Runner cover Taos and Albuquerque.



DESTINATION	GETTING THERE	BEST AS
Taos & the High Road	1 h 30 by the Low Road, 2 h 30+ by the High Road; free Blue Bus 300/305	2 nights
Abiquiú & Ghost Ranch	1 h 15 by car on US-84	Long day or overnight
Bandelier, Los Alamos & Valles Caldera	1 h by car; Bandelier shuttle to 14 Oct	Full day
Ojo Caliente	1 h by car on US-285	Day or overnight
Albuquerque	Rail Runner 1 h 30 (seniors free Wednesdays)	Day
Turquoise Trail: Cerrillos & Madrid	45 min by car on NM-14	Half or full day
Tent Rocks or Jemez Springs	50 min / 1 h 45 by car	Day (Tent Rocks by reservation)
Pecos & Las Golondrinas	30 min / 20 min by car	Half days

Taos & the High Road



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Hprather3 • CC BY-SA 4.0

GETTING THERE Go up by the High Road (about 135 km): US-84 to Pojoaque, then through Chimayó, Córdova, Truchas and Las Trampas on NM-76 and into Taos; come back by the Low Road along the Rio Grande (NM-68, 1 h 30). Without a car, the free Blue Bus runs Santa Fe–Taos (route 200/300 on weekdays, 305 Taos Express at weekends).

A LITTLE HISTORY

People have lived continuously in Taos Pueblo's multi-storey adobe houses for about 1,000 years (UNESCO, 1992). Spanish settlers founded Don Fernando de Taos around 1615; painters arrived in 1898 and formed the Taos Society of Artists in 1915, and Mabel Dodge Luhan's house (1917–22) hosted D. H. Lawrence, Willa Cather, O'Keeffe and Ansel Adams.

THINGS TO DO

Chimayó

El Santuario and its pit of “holy dirt”, then lunch at Rancho de Chimayó (Tue–Sun), run by the Jaramillo family since 1965.

Taos Pueblo & the plaza

The pueblo in the morning (\$25, seniors \$22), then the plaza and the Harwood Museum (Wed–Sun).

The High Road villages

Weaving shops in Córdova and Truchas, and the 1760s San José de Gracia church at Las Trampas.

The Gorge & the Earthships

Look 200 m down from the Rio Grande Gorge Bridge, then on to the Earthship Visitor Center (\$9).

Tips: San Geronimo feast is 29–30 Sept. Taos Pueblo closes for about 8–10 weeks in late winter and on ceremonial days — call 575-758-1028. The Millicent Rogers Museum closes Wednesdays, the Harwood Mon–Tue.

LONG DAY OR OVERNIGHT · 1 H 15 BY CAR

Abiquiú & Ghost Ranch



Artotem from Here, There, and... · CC BY 2.0



Artotem from Here, There, and... · CC BY 2.0

GETTING THERE US-84/285 north to Española, then US-84 north-west: 85 km to the O'Keeffe Welcome Center, 105 km to Ghost Ranch. Home & Studio tours (March–November) must be booked: \$65 standard, \$85 extended.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Georgia O'Keeffe first came to Ghost Ranch in the 1930s and in 1945 bought a ruined adobe in Abiquiú village, restoring it as her home and studio. The red cliffs and flat-topped Cerro Pedernal around the ranch fill her paintings; Ghost Ranch is now a 21,000-acre retreat centre with fossil beds and museums.

THINGS TO DO

O'Keeffe Home & Studio

Book the extended tour from the Welcome Center (Tue–Sun).

Ghost Ranch

A \$10 day pass covers the trails — Chimney Rock is the classic — and the paleontology museum (closed Mondays).

Bode's General Store

A green-chile breakfast burrito at the store that has served travellers since 1893.

Abiquiú Lake

The dam overlook, with Cerro Pedernal across the water.

Tips: Book the O'Keeffe tour as soon as your dates are fixed. There's no Uber or Lyft out here; the Ghost Ranch museums close Mondays.

FULL DAY · 1 H BY CAR

Bandelier, Los Alamos & Valles Caldera



Daniel Mayer (Mav) · CC BY-SA 3.0



Sheila Sund · CC BY 2.0

GETTING THERE US-84/285 to Pojoaque, then NM-502 and NM-4 past White Rock: about 70 km to Bandelier. Bandelier and Valles Caldera are \$25 per car each for 7 days, card only. The free Bandelier shuttle from White Rock runs until 14 Oct; after that you drive into the canyon.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Ancestral Pueblo people carved rooms into the soft volcanic tuff of Frijoles Canyon and built Tyuonyi village between about 1150 and 1550. In 1943 the Manhattan Project took over the Los Alamos Ranch School on the mesa above to build the first atomic bombs. Valles Caldera is a volcanic crater 20 km across.

THINGS TO DO

Bandelier's Main Loop

Past Tyuonyi and the Long House cliff rooms; climb the ladders to Alcove House if open.

Los Alamos history

Fuller Lodge and Bathtub Row, with a map from the National Park Service visitor center.

Bradbury Science Museum

Free exhibits on the Manhattan Project and the lab today (closed Mondays).

Valles Caldera

Elk in the Valle Grande, and the Volcano Discovery Center.

Tips: Go on a weekday. The caldera is at 2,600 m and cold early in the season.

DAY OR OVERNIGHT • 1 H BY CAR

Ojo Caliente



psyberartist · CC BY 2.0

GETTING THERE About 80 km north on US-84/285 through Española. Day soaks \$45 Mon–Thu, \$65 Fri–Sun, 10:00–22:00; private pools \$75 for two for 50 minutes (book 877-977-8212).

A LITTLE HISTORY

Tewa ancestors lived at these springs — pueblo ruins stand on the hill above — and a bathhouse has run here since 1868. Nine pools fed by different mineral waters (iron, soda, lithia, arsenic) run from 27 to 40°C.

THINGS TO DO

The pools

Work through them, including the newly reopened Arsenic Pool.

The mud pool

Seasonal, and as silly as it is good.

A hike

Trails up to the Posi pueblo ruins and old mica mines.

Stay the night

The historic hotel or cottages make it an easy overnight.

Tips: Monday to Thursday is \$20 cheaper and quieter. Swimsuits required; no children under 13.

Albuquerque



a4gpa auf flickr.com · CC BY-SA 2.0



Don McCulley · CC0

GETTING THERE Rail Runner from the Railyard depot to Downtown Albuquerque (about 12 trains on weekdays, fewer at weekends; seniors free on Wednesdays), or 1 h on I-25. Balloon Fiesta runs 3–11 Oct 2026, with dawn mass ascensions on the weekends and Wednesday.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Spanish colonists founded Albuquerque in 1706 around the plaza and San Felipe de Neri church; the railway built a “New Town” in 1880, and Route 66 (Central Avenue) gave it Nob Hill. The Indian Pueblo Cultural Center is owned by the 19 Pueblos of New Mexico.

THINGS TO DO

Old Town

The plaza and San Felipe de Neri church.

Nob Hill & VERS

Route 66 neon, then dinner and a drink at VERS, the new gay-owned bar and restaurant (5001 Central NE).

Indian Pueblo Cultural Center

Galleries, weekend dances and lunch at Indian Pueblo Kitchen.

Sandia Peak Tramway

Up at sunset (closed Tuesdays, and 3–11 Nov for maintenance).

Tips: During Balloon Fiesta, stay in Santa Fe and use the park-and-ride. The Sandia Crest road is closed until 15 Jan 2027 — take the tram.

HALF OR FULL DAY · 45 MIN BY CAR

The Turquoise Trail



Cathy from USA · CC BY-SA 2.0

GETTING THERE NM-14 south: Cerrillos is 40 km, Madrid 45 km. Loop back via Albuquerque's tram if you like (the Crest road itself is closed until January).

A LITTLE HISTORY

The Cerrillos Hills have been mined for more than 1,100 years; their turquoise reached Chaco Canyon and Mexico. Madrid was a coal company town that emptied in the 1950s and was revived by artists from the 1970s.

THINGS TO DO

Cerrillos

Dirt streets and 8 km of trails in Cerrillos Hills State Park (visitor centre weekends).

Mine Shaft Tavern

Lunch and a drink in Madrid's old miners' bar.

Madrid

Galleries and shops along the one main street.

The views

Ortiz, Sandia and Jemez mountains all the way.

Tips: Many Madrid shops close midweek — go Thursday to Sunday.

Tent Rocks or Jemez Springs



Julius Rückert · CC BY-SA 3.0



Skarz · CC BY-SA 4.0

GETTING THERE Kasha-Katuwe Tent Rocks (60 km via I-25 and Cochiti Pueblo) reopened in February 2026 **by reservation only**, Thursday to Monday, entry 7:45–13:00: a \$6 BLM ticket on Recreation.gov plus a \$20 Cochiti Pueblo access pass. Closed 15 Dec–31 Jan. Jemez Springs is 130 km via Los Alamos and the caldera.

A LITTLE HISTORY

The cones formed from volcanic ash and pumice 6–7 million years ago, harder caprocks protecting the soft tuff beneath, on Cochiti Pueblo's ancestral land. At Jemez, the 700-year-old village of Giusewa and the stone mission of San José (1621) stand side by side.

THINGS TO DO

Canyon Trail

2.4 km each way through a slot canyon to the mesa-top view.

Jemez Historic Site

A paved trail through Giusewa and the mission ruins (\$7, Wed–Sun).

Cave Loop

The easier 2 km loop.

Soda Dam & a soak

The travertine dam on NM-4, then the Jemez Springs Bath House.

Tips: Tent Rocks tickets are released quarterly and sell out — book early. Little shade; start in the morning.

HALF DAYS · 20–30 MIN BY CAR

Pecos & El Rancho de las Golondrinas



Amarie0x · CC0



NewMexicophotographer1 · CC BY-SA 4.0

GETTING THERE Pecos National Historical Park is 40 km east on I-25 and NM-50 (free). Las Golondrinas is 25 km south (I-25 exit 276): \$10 (62+ \$8), open Wed–Sun until early November.

A LITTLE HISTORY

In the 1400s Pecos Pueblo was one of the largest pueblos, a trading hub between Pueblo and Plains peoples; the mission ruins are 1700s, and the Union won the Battle of Glorieta Pass nearby in 1862. Las Golondrinas was a stopping place on the Camino Real and is now a 500-acre living-history museum.

THINGS TO DO

Pecos Ancestral Sites Trail

2 km through the pueblo and mission ruins.

Las Golondrinas

The 10:30 guided tour; the Harvest Festival is 3 Oct 2026.

Glorieta Battlefield Trail

The “Gettysburg of the West”.

Las Vegas, NM

Another hour on: the Plaza Hotel and a Victorian railroad district.

Tips: Golondrinas closes for the winter in early November — confirm dates before going.

Sources & credits

- Tourism Santa Fe — Plaza & downtown; LGBTQ+ travel
- New Mexico Museum of Art — Visit
- New Mexico History Museum
- NM CulturePass
- Georgia O'Keeffe Museum — tickets; new museum; Home & Studio
- IAIA Museum of Contemporary Native Arts
- Cathedral Basilica of St Francis
- San Miguel Chapel
- Capitol Art Collection
- Santa Fe New Mexican — Pink Adobe & Dragon Room reopen (May 2026)
- Santa Fe Reporter — Best of Santa Fe 2026
- MICHELIN Guide — Santa Fe
- Museum of International Folk Art
- Museum of Indian Arts & Culture
- Wheelwright Museum
- Nuevo Mexicano Heritage Arts Museum
- Santa Fe Botanical Garden
- SITE Santa Fe
- Santa Fe Farmers' Market
- Meow Wolf Santa Fe
- Ten Thousand Waves
- Ski Santa Fe — events
- Randall Davey Audubon Center
- Santa Fe Opera
- City of Santa Fe — transit fares
- NCRTD Blue Bus — fares & routes
- Rio Metro — Rail Runner fares
- NMShuttle — Albuquerque airport shuttle
- Human Rights Alliance — Santa Fe Pride & PRIDE Center
- Gay Santa Fe — Friends of Dorothy
- El Rey Court — Queer Night at La Reina
- Garrett Peck — LGBTQ+ Santa Fe tour
- Albuquerque Journal — VERS opens (July 2026)
- Inn of the Turquoise Bear
- Taos Pueblo — hours
- National Park Service — Bandelier shuttle & fees
- BLM — Kasha-Katuwe Tent Rocks reopening

- [Ojo Caliente — soaking](#)
- [Balloon Fiesta 2026](#)
- [El Rancho de las Golondrinas](#)
- [Santa Fe Fiesta — event calendar](#)
- [US registration rule for Canadians \(Snowbird Advisor, Sept 2026\)](#)

Maps: © OpenStreetMap contributors. Geocoding: Photon (OpenStreetMap). Prices, hours, fares and dates were checked in late September 2026; state museums switch to winter hours (closed Mondays) from November, so always confirm before you go.

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